

Fasal Seva – Startup Strategy Document

Updated: February 2026 Product Status: LIVE on Google Play Store | 64 Users | ₹0 Funding Raised
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Executive Summary

Fasal Seva is a **live, free precision farming app** on the Google Play Store (com.fasalseva.app) targeting India's 120M+ small and medium farmers. The app already ships an industry-leading feature set: full-duplex AI voice calls (Sevak Live, Gemini 3.0), 5-index satellite monitoring (Sentinel-2), FAO-56 smart irrigation engine, AR field visualization, walk-mode field mapping, and 14-day weather intelligence – all for free.

Current status:

- 64 real users on Play Store
- Zero funding raised (fully bootstrapped)
- IoT soil sensor (Fasal Seva Mini – BT 5.0, IP67) testing with 2 farmers
- Hindi, English, Tamil language support
- Website: fasalseva.in

The **core challenge** is no longer building the product – it's **commercializing it**. Revenue model, user growth, hardware scaling, and fundraising are the priorities for the next 90 days.

1. BUSINESS MODEL – NEEDS RETHINKING

Current Reality

The app is **completely free**. There are no paid tiers, no subscriptions, no hardware revenue at scale. This was the right move to get initial users and validate the product, but it's not a business yet.

Revenue Model Options (To Be Tested)

Model	Description	Pros	Cons	Priority
Freemium SaaS	Keep core features free; charge for advanced satellite analytics, unlimited voice calls, detailed PDF reports	Natural upgrade path; low friction	Farmers may not pay; need to identify what's worth paying for	HIGH – test first
IoT Hardware Sales	Sell Fasal Seva Mini sensor at margin	Tangible product; clear value add	Hardware not ready to scale; only 2 pilots; manufacturing risk	MEDIUM – when ready
B2B Data Licensing	Sell aggregated, anonymized crop/soil/satellite data to insurers, input companies, government	High margin; scalable; doesn't charge farmers	Need 10,000+ users for meaningful data; privacy concerns	MEDIUM-TERM

Government Contracts	Deploy as precision ag platform for state agriculture departments, Digital Agriculture Mission	Large contracts; subsidy funding available	Slow sales cycle; procurement complexity	MEDIUM-TERM
Input Company Partnerships	Crop-specific recommendations → referral/affiliate to seed/fertilizer brands	Doesn't charge farmer; proven model (DeHaat, AgroStar)	Needs scale; conflict of interest risk	LONG-TERM
White-Label Platform	License the tech stack to other agritech companies, NGOs, or international markets	High margin; scales without farmer acquisition	Diverts focus from core product	LONG-TERM

Recommended Monetization Path

Phase 1 (Now – Month 3): Stay Free, Grow Users

- Keep app free. Priority is getting to 500+ MAU.
- Introduce optional premium features to test willingness to pay:
 - Daily (instead of 3-5 day) satellite updates
 - Unlimited Sevak Live voice calls (cap free tier at 5/day)
 - Detailed multi-season analytics
 - Priority support

Phase 2 (Month 3-6): Test Freemium

- Introduce "Kisan Plus" at ₹49-99/month
- Track conversion rate. Target: 10-15% of MAU converting.
- If conversion is below 5%, the value prop isn't strong enough for paid – pivot to B2B monetization.

Phase 3 (Month 6-12): Hardware + Data Revenue

- Scale IoT sensor from 2 to 100+ farmers
- Price sensor at hardware cost + 30-40% margin (₹3,000-5,000 range, TBD based on actual BOM)
- Begin packaging aggregated data for insurance/input company pilots

Unit Economics – HONEST ASSESSMENT

Current State: No Revenue, No Unit Economics

What we know:

- App development: bootstrapped (founder time + cloud costs)
- Satellite data: free (Sentinel-2)
- AI costs: Gemini 3.0 API costs per voice call (need to measure)
- Per-user server/API cost: unknown but likely ₹10-50/month at current scale

What we don't know:

- Willingness to pay (for premium features or hardware)
- IoT sensor BOM at scale (only 2 prototypes deployed)
- Customer acquisition cost through channels (organic only so far)
- Retention beyond early adopter phase

IoT Sensor Unit Economics (Estimated – NOT PROVEN):

- Current prototype cost: unknown (need to audit)
 - Target BOM at 1,000 units: ₹1,500-2,500 (TBD)
 - Target selling price: ₹3,000-5,000
 - Target gross margin: 40-60%
 - □ **These are estimates. Real numbers need hardware manufacturing quotes.**
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2. GO-TO-MARKET STRATEGY

Phase 1: Organic Growth (Now – Month 3)

Priority: Get from 64 to 500+ users without spending money.

Tactics:

1. **Play Store optimization** – improve listing, screenshots, Hindi description, keywords
2. **YouTube content** – farmer-friendly demo videos in Hindi showing Sevak Live, satellite features
3. **WhatsApp viral loops** – shareable field reports, "share with a farmer friend" prompts
4. **Agricultural social media** – Facebook farming groups, Koo, ShareChat (rural India platforms)
5. **Existing user activation** – get 64 current users to refer peers; understand why they signed up
6. **KVK outreach** – demo to 5-10 Krishi Vigyan Kendras in states where users already exist

Phase 2: Channel Growth (Month 3-6)

Priority: Test 2-3 distribution channels with small budgets.

1. FPOs (Farmer Producer Organizations)

- Partner with 5-10 FPOs for structured pilots
- Offer free app + priority features for FPO members
- When hardware is ready: bulk pricing for FPO-level deployment
- **Target: 5 FPO partnerships → 500-1,500 new users**

2. KVK Demo Farms

- Place IoT sensors on 5-10 KVK demonstration plots
- KVK scientists validate and recommend to visiting farmers
- **Target: 10 KVK partnerships → credibility + word of mouth**

3. Progressive Farmer Network

- Identify 1 lead farmer per target village
- Give them IoT sensor (from testing batch) + premium features
- They become local ambassadors
- **Target: 20 lead farmers → 200-400 followers**

Phase 3: Scaled Distribution (Month 6-12)

Only pursue after validating retention and willingness to pay:

- Agri-input dealer network
- Government procurement/subsidy channels
- CSC/VLE network
- State agriculture department partnerships

Reaching Farmers Who Don't Know About Apps

Channel	How It Works	Cost
FPO monthly meetings	Demo + group onboarding	Free (time only)
Mandi (APMC market) activation	Demo stall during selling hours	₹5,000-10,000 per mandi day
Kisan melas (agri fairs)	State-level fairs, 50K-500K footfall	₹10,000-50,000 per event
YouTube/WhatsApp content	Hindi video tutorials showing real features	Free (time only)
Progressive farmer referrals	Word of mouth from lead users	Free device to lead farmer

3. FIRST 90-DAY ACTION PLAN (FROM CURRENT STATE)

The product is LIVE. The 90-day plan is about growth, monetization testing, and fundraising – not building.

Week 1-2: Understand Current Users

- ☐ Talk to all 64 users (or as many as possible) – phone calls in Hindi/Tamil
- ☐ Document: How did they find the app? Which features do they use? What's missing? Would they pay?
- ☐ Measure: DAU/MAU ratio, feature usage, voice call frequency, satellite view frequency
- ☐ Identify top 5-10 "power users" as potential farmer ambassadors
- ☐ Audit Gemini 3.0 API costs – what does each voice call cost?

Week 3-4: Optimize for Growth

- ☐ Revamp Play Store listing based on user feedback (better screenshots, Hindi video)
- ☐ Create 3 YouTube demo videos in Hindi (Sevak Live, satellite mapping, field mapping)
- ☐ Set up referral mechanism in app (share field report → invite link)
- ☐ Identify 5 FPOs in states where users already exist; make first contact
- ☐ Contact 3-5 KVKs for demo farm partnerships

Week 5-6: Test Monetization

- ☐ Implement basic premium tier in app (Kisan Plus – ₹49/month or ₹499/year)
- ☐ Premium features: daily satellite updates, unlimited voice calls, multi-season analytics
- ☐ Track: how many users see the paywall? How many convert? What's the objection?
- ☐ Start conversations with 2-3 crop insurance companies about data partnerships

Week 7-8: Hardware Progress

- ☐ Get IoT sensor feedback from 2 current test farmers – what works, what doesn't
- ☐ Get manufacturing quotes for 50-100 unit batch
- ☐ Define pricing strategy for IoT sensor based on actual BOM

- ☐ Deploy sensors with 5-10 more farmers (expand from 2 to 10-12)
- ☐ Document sensor reliability data (connection stability, battery life, accuracy)

Week 9-10: Fundraising Prep

- ☐ Compile metrics: users, DAU/MAU, voice calls per user, satellite views, retention curves
- ☐ Build investor pitch deck with REAL numbers (64 users, 2 hardware pilots, zero funding, feature comparison)
- ☐ Identify 20 target investors (see Section 4)
- ☐ Get warm intros to top 5 investors
- ☐ Apply to 3 agritech incubators/accelerators

Week 11-12: First Fundraise Push

- ☐ Begin investor conversations
- ☐ Target: ₹25-50 lakh pre-seed (enough for 6 months of hardware testing + growth)
- ☐ Continue user growth – target 200+ users by end of 90 days
- ☐ Document first FPO partnership results
- ☐ Plan next quarter based on what's working

4. FUNDING ROADMAP

The Fundraising Story

"We built the most comprehensive precision farming app in India – with zero funding. It's live on Play Store with 64 real farmers. Our feature set surpasses competitors who've raised \$20M+. Now we need capital to scale hardware and find our revenue model."

This is a strong narrative because:

- Live product > concept/prototype
- Zero funding = capital efficient founder
- Feature comparison against funded competitors is dramatic
- Clear next milestones (not "we need money to build")

Pre-Seed (₹25-50 Lakhs | Now)

Use of funds:

- IoT sensor batch (50-100 units): ₹5-10L
- Cloud/API costs for 1,000+ users: ₹2-3L
- On-ground pilot operations (travel, demos, FPO partnerships): ₹5-7L
- Part-time hires (field coordinator, content creator): ₹5-8L
- Working capital: ₹5-10L

Sources:

- **Angel investors** – the "zero funding, live product, 64 users" story resonates with angels
- **100X.VC** – ₹1.25 Cr for 5% equity (standardized, agritech-friendly)
- **Startup India Seed Fund** – up to ₹50L through DPIIT-recognized incubators
- **RKVY-RAFTAAR** – up to ₹25L for agri startups
- **Agri-focused angels** – Hemendra Mathur, Jinesh Shah, members of Indian Angel Network

Seed Round (₹1-3 Crore | Month 6-12)

Milestones needed:

- 1,000+ MAU (up from 64)
- Freemium conversion data (even if low, need to test)
- 20+ IoT sensors deployed with reliability data
- 5+ FPO partnerships
- 3+ farmer impact stories with data
- Clear revenue model identified (even if early)

Target investors:

- **Omnivore** (India's only agri-VC, ₹1-5Cr seed sweet spot)
- **Ankur Capital** (impact + agri focus)
- **Avaana Capital** (climate/sustainability)
- **Aavishkaar Capital** (impact investing, rural India)
- **Better Capital** (pre-seed/seed, founder-friendly)
- **Social Alpha** (Tata Trusts, deep science + impact)

Government Grants & Schemes

Scheme	Amount	Notes
BIRAC BIG	Up to ₹50L	Agri/biotech innovation
Startup India Seed Fund	Up to ₹50L	Through DPIIT incubators
RKVY-RAFTAAR	Up to ₹25-50L	Agri startup specific
NABARD Innovation Fund	Up to ₹50L	FPO-linked agritech
Meity TIDE 2.0	Up to ₹7-30L	Tech startups
MSME/CGTMSE	Collateral-free loans up to ₹2Cr	Any registered MSME

Agritech Incubators (Apply Immediately)

1. **RKVY-RAFTAAR** – free money + mentorship
2. **Social Alpha / Villgro** – investment + incubation
3. **ICRISAT Agri-Business Incubator** – Hyderabad, field trial access
4. **IIM Ahmedabad CIIE** – strong mentor/investor network
5. **TNAU Agri Incubator** – deep agri domain

5. TEAM NEEDS

Immediate (Next 30 Days)

Role	Priority	Monthly Cost	Why
Field Coordinator (part-time)	HIGH	₹15-25K	Someone on the ground talking to farmers, running demos, collecting feedback

Content Creator (part-time)	HIGH	₹10-20K	Hindi YouTube videos, WhatsApp content, Play Store optimization
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Next 90 Days (Post Pre-Seed)

Role	Priority	Monthly CTC	Why
Hardware/Embedded Engineer	HIGH	₹60-80K	Scale IoT sensor from prototype to production-ready
Growth/Community Manager	MEDIUM	₹30-50K	FPO relationships, farmer onboarding, referral programs
Agri-Domain Advisor (part-time)	MEDIUM	₹20-30K	Former KVK scientist or extension officer for credibility + farmer trust

Don't Hire Yet

- Full-time mobile developer (founder can manage)
- Marketing team (too early for marketing spend)
- Finance/HR (founder handles)
- Customer support team (founder + field coordinator handle at current scale)

6. RISKS AND MITIGATION

1. Revenue Model Risk (HIGHEST PRIORITY)

Risk: The app is free. Hardware isn't ready to scale. There's currently no path to revenue.

Mitigation:

- Test freemium in next 30 days – even small conversion data is informative
- Explore B2B revenue (insurance data, government contracts) in parallel
- Keep burn ultra-low until revenue model is validated
- Hardware margin could be primary revenue once sensor is ready to scale

2. Hardware Scaling Risk

Risk: IoT sensor is only testing with 2 farmers. Manufacturing, quality, distribution, and pricing are all unproven.

Mitigation:

- Don't bet the company on hardware. Software-first growth is working.
- Get manufacturing quotes for 50-100 units before committing
- Expand pilot to 10-20 farmers before ordering 1,000+
- Design for field conditions from the start (IP67 is already right)
- Budget 10% of units as warranty reserve

3. User Growth Risk

Risk: 64 users could plateau. Organic growth from Play Store is unpredictable.

Mitigation:

- Understand current users deeply – what drove them? How do they use it?
- YouTube + WhatsApp content for discoverability
- FPO partnerships for structured growth
- Don't spend money on paid acquisition until retention is proven

4. AI Cost Risk

Risk: Gemini 3.0 API costs for full-duplex voice calls could be high at scale.

Mitigation:

- Measure current per-call cost immediately
- Set daily call limits on free tier
- Explore cheaper models for simple queries (reserve Gemini for complex conversations)
- Voice call frequency capping is acceptable – farmers don't need unlimited AI calls

5. Competition Risk

Risk: Well-funded competitors (Fasal \$20M, CropIn \$45M, DeHaat \$350M) could copy features.

Mitigation:

- Feature depth is already ahead. The gap would take 12-18 months to close.
- Free pricing is a moat – competitors have business models that require charging.
- Voice AI (Sevak Live) quality is hard to replicate without deep investment.
- Hardware moat will strengthen once sensor is deployed at scale.

6. Founder Risk

Risk: Solo founder building a hardware + software + AI product across rural India.

Mitigation:

- Find a co-founder or strong domain advisor (agri background) immediately
- Join an incubator for mentorship and network
- Keep the product focused – don't try to do everything at once
- Lean on FPOs and KVKs for on-ground execution (don't try to be everywhere personally)

7. INVESTOR PITCH POSITIONING

The Narrative

Opening:

"We built the most feature-rich precision farming app in India – and put it on Play Store for free. Zero funding. 64 real farmers using it today. Our satellite monitoring has 5 indices. Our irrigation engine uses FAO-56 Penman-Monteith. Our voice AI – Sevak Live – lets farmers have full-duplex conversations with AI about their farm in Hindi. Competitors with \$20M in funding don't have half of this."

The Problem:

India has 120 million small farmers. They make irrigation, fertilizer, and harvest decisions by intuition. Existing precision agriculture tools cost ₹25,000+ and speak English. 86% of farmers are small/marginal. They need intelligence, not expensive hardware.

The Solution:

Fasal Seva is a free mobile app with: full-duplex AI voice calls (Sevak Live, Gemini 3.0), 5-index satellite monitoring (Sentinel-2), FAO-56 smart irrigation engine, AR field visualization, walk-mode field mapping, and 14-day weather intelligence. Plus an IoT soil sensor in testing.

Traction:

- Live on Google Play Store (com.fasalseva.app)
- 64 real users, zero funding
- IoT sensor piloting with 2 farmers
- Feature set surpasses \$20M-funded competitors

The Ask:

Raising ₹25-50 lakhs to: scale to 500+ users, expand IoT sensor pilot to 50 farmers, test monetization, and prove unit economics for seed round.

Key Metrics to Track

Metric	Current	90-Day Target
Play Store users	64	200+
MAU	TBD (measure now)	150+
DAU/MAU ratio	TBD	30%+
Voice calls/user/week	TBD	2+
Satellite views/user/week	TBD	3+
IoT sensors deployed	2	10-20
FPO partnerships	0	5+
Revenue	₹0	Any (even ₹1 proves willingness to pay)
Freemium conversion	N/A	Test and measure

APPENDIX: Key Numbers for Reference

Metric	Value	Source
Fasal Seva Play Store users	64	Play Store (Feb 2026)
Funding raised	₹0	—
IoT sensor pilots	2 farmers	Internal
Languages supported	Hindi, English, Tamil	Play Store
Satellite indices	5 (NDVI, NDWI, NDRE, SAVI, MSI)	Product
AI model	Gemini 3.0 Native Audio	Product
Small/marginal farmers in India	~120M (86% of all)	Agriculture Census
Indian agritech market (2025)	~\$4-5B	EY/NASSCOM

Closest competitor funding	Fasal (co.) ~\$20M	Public data
Closest competitor pricing	▫25,000-50,000+	Public data

This is a living strategy document. Update weekly with real data as the product grows. The best strategy is one that adapts to what farmers and the market actually tell you.